



THE ICONOCLAST

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the afternoon drink

by Sara M. Larson

drunken heartbowl ruby moon
swallow me in the afternoon
as i sulk to swallow you

spoil with flushes this sunken brood
smear with bodily flesh you swell
of ruined fruit
bloody, blushed
ruby me as i ruby you.

o ruby ruby ruby moon
this flunkie rotten swoon for two
ever our tomb our room we loom unsouber beauty
moon to moon.

the hallows blacken soon
night gongs and god-wrung mornings
room to room to room.
'fore we come to
bleary gloomed ash blue
come wallow in bloom of me
as i wallow in bloom of you
grow secrets in the tumblers
for you i unscrew my touched womb
o ruby moon
o ruby ruby ruby moon

KIDDING AROUND WITH EZRA POUND¹

by John Fazcycek

Mr. Pound, a few questions
What are your feelings on traditional romantic poetry?
MAKE IT NEW!
O.K., how about current social terrors such as AIDS virus.
MAKE IT NEW!
I see, and in regards to the civil rights movement?
MAKE IT NEW!
Ah ha, and the Iran-Contra Affair?
MAKE IT NEW!
Thank you for your time.

¹Title written in "modern" font

to ezra pound on his 112 birthday

march 22, 1997
andrea chrisman

your coffee-stained villainy
haunts the trunk of my Honda.
your strangle hold crushes vocal chords
as consciousness breathes the mist of creativity
through plastic coffee-stirrers:
rigor mortis corpse concepts
wrapped in jeweled levedity.

your isolationist diatribe sent
poor Mister J. Alfred Prufrock
(the boy nobody loved)
madly singing
cowering among empty trashcan tides
wishing he had mingled more
with Kirk's sea-green girls
in the ocean spray.

the rising waves cover reminders of you
with salt sticky nostalgia.
it is time for funerals:
a freshly planted grave awaits;
roots are boring through coffin-calculated images
of the elite.

you should commend me:
i trudge clumsily through your ogre tracks
in a world teaching economy of spirit.
i walk barefoot into the galleries
tracking mud-slung theories on my soles
singing quietly in the shadows
while grumbling under cheap wine breath
"make it new."

come, we shall walk together-
the babbling fool and the pseudo-intellectual.
plodding through poetry,
we can sing of worlds gone perfect
and shatter them with a waiver of the pen.

Untitled

by Bruce Kramer

you want her
 walking by
 canvas to paint your eyes over
 black high heels
 long brown hair
 not much else in between
 (except for the navel ring)
 disco ball lights lasering through the thick booming dance
 music
 you sit and smoke and stare and fantasize
 damn it
 if you only had another \$1
 having spent the last one on the red head
 with the tattoo of the sun on her back near her ass
 few of the other slobs
 (you're not one of them of course)
 clapping as the new one climbs
 17? 18 at the most with her black boots and too much
 makeup
 (you'd do her anyway)
 on stage
 hugging that pole
 writhing on the floor as if the music is her lover
 through smoke and cheers
 she's smiling at you
 damn it
 if you only had another \$1
 to put in your mouth
 to put between her breasts
 she must really like you
 she isn't the worth the \$5 in your pocket though
 none of these whores are
 you want her
 maybe give her the 71
 --69 with 2 fingers up her ass--
 (oh you are quite witty)
 alas her mouth is your hand after an erection filled drive
 home
 and you fuck her
 and fuck her
 and fuck her

Emotional Champagne

by Anthony Simeone

I can't see your eyes again.
 Let me put the knife down
 and hold you.
 The pretty pictures can wait.
 Sit down, sit down.
 I know you
 love me...
 Adore me...
 Be angry at me, I beg you.
 Oh please blink, and make it rain
 so I can see your eyes again.
 Distilled passion in a tear,
 so many caught in my bottle.
 Let's drink it all,
 finally finish it.
 Allow intoxication by sorrow
 one more time before we
 break the bottle at last,
 shatter our world open tonight.
 Smash it, Smash it!
 Start to make a life again.
 Dreams can trick you
 into dancing all night,
 but we know our heads will hurt tomorrow.
 Oh, to make my fantasies serve me again...
 NO! I don't touch the stuff anymore.
 They left me with the truth,
 what a bitter brew.
 Here, take a sip, save some for me!
 AH! A very subtle blend of you and me.
 I'm sober now.

In Nature's Way by Matthew W. Weatherbee

A dog barks in heat
 Tack and harness upon a horse.

Bugs on a Window Sill

andrea chrisman

Thoughts of whisper wonders on faces of the dead
 Dreaming of pens and poetry



Drive-Thru Confessionals For Catholics On The Go

Given Unto Thee By Charles Bakerson With Divine Inspiration Provided By His High Holiness Pope Arn I

I am huddled in the perfect, landscaped bushes that grow in artificial splendor around what appears to be a typical fast food restaurant. Indeed, it seems to be a rather innocuous establishment. It could pass, when given a cursory glance, for any one of the numerous fast food places that dot the country. But upon more careful scrutiny, the place is easily recognized as not being among the quintessential fast food fare. Let's take a closer look.

One immediately notices there are no golden arches or the like adorning the facade of the place. Instead, a giant halo rests upon its roof. Beneath the neon glory of that magnificent circle is the equally brilliant name of the place: McPriest. The names that grace the faces of similar places of modern confession convenience come to mind: Burger Christ, Pope in the Box, T.G.I. Friar's...their names are legion. They all provide the

over-stressed but faithful a much-needed service...the drive-thru confessional! Just recently sanctioned by Pope John Jacob Jinglehiemerschmitt I, these god-sent edifices provide absolution for those too busy to attend confession in a church. One can simply pull up a Sodomite and pull away as fresh as a new-born saint. And all of this in a matter of minutes.

What a blessing, you say? Ah, intrepid reader, you have yet to see the staff of McPriest in soul-saving action. Look, we're in luck! Here comes a sinner now! Quite an opulent fellow...that is a big Cadillac he has there, indeed! He's rolling down the window as he pulls up to the speaker, which is embedded in the mouth of a life-sized statue of the Pope himself! Let's listen in (forgive us, God!):

Sinner in the car: Forgive me, Father, for I am late for work. It has been 80 days since my last confession. Since then I have masturbated 127 times, and also had covetous thoughts about the neighbor's pit bull terrier.

Voice from the Speaker: (after a short pause) That'll be four Hail Mary's and two Our Father's. Please pull around to the first window.

See? It's that easy! Now watch as the priest-on-premises, resplendent in his holy robe-like uniform, leans out of the window to bless the poor sinner. Watch as he makes the sign of the cross, sprinkles some holy water, and blows incense into the sinner's face all in one motion! He's even giving the sinner a free order of palms and a tiny plastic statue of the Virgin Mary that sticks onto the dashboard. Truly a blessing! Now the repentant man drives off with a clear conscience. And the whole process took only about a minute. It's no wonder places like McPriest have been given the nickname "The Microwaves of God"! Now, if we could listen in on the man that was just blessed, we would probably hear him chanting the Hail Mary's and Our Father's that the drive-thru priest prescribed as he speeds on to work. How, one may ask, is this possible? Aren't those prayers supposed to

be said while the person saying them is curled up into an almost fetal position? Well, this used to be the case. But thanks to a recent Papal Decree, one may say prayers at any time and in any position. Thank goodness the Pope in power is very aware of the needs of modern times. So with eyes wide open and hands on the wheel, our man in the humble Cadillac says his prayers while weaving through traffic at extreme rates of speed. I, for one, am so glad the Catholic church has come to have such modern sensibilities. Perhaps God is finally giving into man's desires, supplying our demands. Indeed, as my priest says during mass every Sunday, "God is bitchin"! Well, it has been a pleasure showing you the hand of the Big Guy Upstairs in action. And until the next time we journey together into places and words, may that divine hand give your life a holy high-five!



The Papal Decree of the Week

Thou Shalt Title thy poetry else thou must listen to the artist formerly known as Prince until thy ears bleed and thy brain liquifies until it slowly seeps out thy tear ducts then vaporizing into an odorless and colourless gas. In addition, thou shalt listen to Vogon poetry until Douglas Adams comes to rescue thy sorry unimaginative melted mind from the deepest reaches of space with his babblefish remover and takes you to the Resteraunt at the End of the Universe in the ship with the Improbability drive....

Spirit as Landscape by Tommy Wright Jr.

I

he saw stars in the ash bowl
 trickling light of heaven
 & knew of little else,
 soon held by a memory
 terrain of a history,
 trickling light of heaven
 illuminated passage,
 seen above the bough
 an end to lunar evolution,
 a naked tree bowing,
 soldier of winters,
 seen above the bough
 angels and discordance
 them pressing onward
 expiation into fractions,
 this the soul of the land
 a form of pain on white
 pure & thus arrogant,
 angels and discordance
 fled to the dream husk
 & he alone with the earth
 he with the suffering land,
 what is felt before hope
 stronger than the imagined
 & he alone with the earth
 a form of pain on white
 extended his arms to the dawn tip
 became the shudder that moved
 that moved through the forest
 a thousand waking birds,
 their hunger aimed toward heaven.

Spam by Scott Eastwood

Spam Spam
 What is Spam?
 Is it chicken, is it ham?
 Come on man.
 What kind of meat comes packed in a can?

II

a sky dreaming of itself into grey,
 that patch of earth where colors grew
 having a name no longer voiced;
 yet the texture of an eye, now course, sunless,
 is remembered through the long months;
 the stillness, the punishment of leaves
 & no horizon imminent...
 hours evolving into days, days, birthing weeks
 & if the land was colder
 it was more real,
 though in this he found no relevance,
 not with the absence of communion,
 with the absence of what is warm.
 & those angels sigh, that forest motions:
 this is the song of the night,
 it reminds him of what is had no more.
 & when daybreak occurs
 its splendor obscured,
 a sky dreaming itself into rain,
 raining to drown,
 drowning to feel.

Untitled by swalker@pop.tiac.net

A clam sings in Brooklyn
 A clam sings alone
 A clam sings in Brooklyn
 Someone calls him on the phone

A frog reads in Tulsa
 A frog reads alone
 A frog reads in Tulsa
 Then calls a clam up on the phone

BLUE IN GREEN
 Breakfast, lunch & coffee
 7 N. Third Street
 Philadelphia, PA 19106
 215 928-5880

STEVE-THE HOT DOG MAN
 Condemned by the gods to poverty.
 Resident Greek scholar at Rutgers
 and a trained professional.

Beauty is Skin Deep With Me

by Bruce Kramer

beauty is skin deep with me
peel back my chromatic exoskeleton
and watch the liquid fire escape

take the shades off the windows to my soul
and see my high viscosity thoughts
clinging to my heart
drowning it

look into my pools of green
and know that I will break you
that I am out of control

look out

someone let my mind out
it's barreling down the road at you
singing its screech
burning across my blackness

broken glass, twisted metal, rusted pain
the painful rust of my mind

my soul wants out too
it's digesting me from the inside
ripping at my entrails to get out

it longs to dance its way out of my mouth
in the form of thick caramel words

feel the explosion rip my minds container
my ultra violet heart
the cause of my cancer filled thoughts

get out of my way



The Iconoclast, winner of the Harvey Hurricane award for literature, would love to have your submissions of poetry, prose, essay, or general foolishness. Do not be intimidated by our genius, we would still like to be able to make fun of your ridiculousness. Send submissions to The Iconoclast, c/o P.O. Box 2133, Cinnaminson, NJ 08077 or email them to p00h@clam.rutgers.edu (the O's are zeroes my friends).

Titles Suck by Jonathan Faszczuk

He is from the streets of Camden
But his heart dwells in every urban fire
We board the bullet together and engage in a sitting high speed

Yes he blows his nose into his hand
Yes he smells of cheap liquor

But why?
Why the piercing eyes?
Everywhere piercing eyes
Relentless
Sucking the glow left in a man

Yes I watch him too
as he rolls up tobacco heaven
and becomes brilliant with anticipation
And I feel a guilt
weighing me down like royal British armor

But you!
You with your mascara and multicolored clothes
You who define the fortunate among us
Contradict with your actions.

You look at savage's meager joy
and you laugh
You look to me and wait for my laughter
but it never comes
You will not experience the domino effect today lady

We have not seen the humor together
although you continue to await my realization
but it never comes

What is so goddamn funny

At least the man in back of you
restricts himself to an exhibition of a bewildered
penetrating stare of pity

But you!
You wretched confused one
You laugh and hold your purse

What is so funny
What is so goddamn funny?

From the Pens of Bitch & Moan *Bitch*

Seeing Double

by Obi Moan Kenobi

Ladies and gentlemen, boys and girls, esteemed readers of the Iconoclast, leave it up to Bitch and Moan to always be on the cusp of modern technology. Thanks to the wonders of cloning, we are proud to present both sides of one issue from one person. Yes you heard it right. We have cloned Bitch so he can argue

with himself. So while I shall be off on a safari chasing the elusive Slappy Stink Monkey through the jungles of Ziare, my counterpart shall be doing double the work and still only getting one paycheck. Ta Ta.

Allow Me to Introduce myself. . . And myself, and myself, and myself or We Don't Need No Steenking Morals

By John Jacob Jinglehiemer Bitch

Yes it is true. I have been spawned through the wonders of modern technology. There are many people in the world who have spoken adamantly out against cloning. These people obviously do not see the positive side of the issue. All they do is drop that H word. "Hitler". If someone was to clone Hitler we would at least know how to defeat him having done it already. When a totally new striving to be world dictator comes along through the random birth process is when we have a problem. And then comes the proclamation that we should not play God. We will not play God. We will BE God! Oh it is truly a Brave New World we are on the fringes of, reader. Think of all the positive things that can come out of this. We can totally remove the randomness from life. There have already been enough great minds come down the pike that we need only to clone them. Think of the people we could bring together. Edison and Einstein. Franklin and Socrates. Beethoven and Lennon. If we only had this technology in 1963. Imagine Lee Harvey Oswald's face as the JFK in the motorcade is dying, another leaps from behind a tree saying "Nah, nah. You missed me." There would be no more endangered species. In fact, Iconoclast scientists are working on cloning Slappy Stink

Monkey so this little primate conglomeration of wisdom to every single subscriber. (Slappy Stink Monkeys? Slappy Stink Monki? Slappy Stink Monkuses?) We can bring back Walk Disney and make him sit through It's A Small World After All for eternity. We can clone Shakespeare and make him write soap operas and made for tv movies. We can clone 100 Cathy Lee Giffords and make her work in her own sweat shop making shoes for \$.08 a month. There will be no more hunger. We can clone thousands of cows for beef. No, let's take that one step further. We can clone a thousand Mother Teresas to hand out that beef. Think of what can be done for those who molest children. We can execute them,



clone them and execute them again. Instead of a person getting thirty life sentences, now they can get thirty DEATH sentences. Or we can clone the criminal and make him kill the clone. An eternity of him having to kill himself. And of course think of what the benefits are for you, reader. I can be immortalized. I shall become a concept rather than an individual. Finally, I shall be able to say I AM FOREVER!!! Well, reader, I must be away. There are others who need this knowledge spread to them. Until later then. . .

Someone Stole a Pair of My Genes! by John Jacob Jinglehiemer Bitch

I want to start by saying that I am the real me...aren't I? Argh! Everyone, listen to me! I have seen the face of evil...and it is mine! No, I am not going crazy! I have made the mistake that could be my last! Please, keep reading! Let me explain. I wish to make a statement: Do not, I repeat, DO NOT volunteer for any accelerated-growth cloning experiments, no matter how many cases of beer they promise to give you!!! Don't let them rape your poor little strands of DNA for any reason! There is someone impersonating me...and it's me! AAAAAAH! What was that?! Damn! Okay, I don't have much time...he is out to kill me! Who, you ask? My clone, of course! He found out that the only reason

I wanted to keep him around was for spare parts, like if I needed a new liver after drinking all those beers! And let me tell you, he did not like that one bit! So I get this notice that he has escaped from the cryogenic clone farm the other day...followed by a note made from letters clipped from newspapers and magazines that said my days are numbered! He's gonna use ME for spare parts, I tell ya! That...that...guy who looks like me is taking over my life! He's with my girlfriend while I'm at work, and working at my job while I am with my girlfriend! Doesn't sound so bad at first, huh? Well, what do you do when you are with your girlfriend, and she is too tired for sex because you both just had sex an hour

Bitch & Moan Continued:

ago...AND YOU WEREN't THERE AN HOUR AGO?! And how about when your boss asks you why you came into work...BECAUSE YOU JUST LEFT 15 MINUTES AGO!? He even got that box of home-made chocolate cookies that my Mom sends me every month! The bastard! That was the sickest crime he committed against me! Nothing is sacred to that abomination ...but he is a rather handsome abomination, I must admit...AAAAAAAARGH! I can't believe I just said that! He has made me feel like I am HIS clone! I can't take it anymore! That guy is a better me than I am! If he doesn't kill me soon, I'll do the job for him...oh, God...it just occurred to me...I could be dead by the time you read this! I guess I am doing what Yule

Brenner did in that anti-cigarette commercial he did before he died! Well this is the most likely late J.J.J. Bitch saying: Now that I am gone...I tell you...don't clone...PLEASE...don't clone! P.S. Nothing is sacred! I just got the latest copy of the Iconoclast, hand delivered by Slappy Stink Monkey himself...or at least by what LOOKS like the REAL Slappy Stink Monkey! It turns out that now, thanks to the curse of cloning, all subscribers to the Iconoclast get a FREE Slappy Stink Monkey! So now not only is a clone going to kill me, there is also a clone running around my house, drinking my beer, spanking himself and giving off a wretched stench!



Brenda by Bertram Redgrave

She's a dog!

Damn that Bogart, he said she was a real looker, long blond hair, deep brown eyes and a great sense of humor, but for christ sakes she's a dog. No getting around it and he's stuck. She has a great personality. Bogart had said, damn why didn't he listen to his own gut, never date someone with a great personality, It's the warning signal every time. Bogart said she was a neighbor he knew who was lonely, her steady had been killed by a car some months before and she was slowly putting her life back together. Real trouble he had thought, but Bogart had been so insistent, please, I like her, Bogart said, she needs someone new, and you know me I've got more females on my hands than I can handle now... yeah, Bogart the big seducer, so he had said ok, why not, maybe this one time would be different so Bogart had arranged their date, she will be waiting on the corner of 2nd and Morgan, and, oh yes, she would be wearing a choker, like the one Pat Boone wore to the music awards...wow, how could you resist

that...just a look see...what's to lose...

Well he was no coward and by damn he had said he would meet her, so waiting for a gap in the light afternoon traffic he crossed the street toward her.

She must have had a good description of him from Bogart for as soon as he reached the corner she spotted him. Damn, no way to duck out now. She is playing it coy though, making him come up and introduce himself. She is so nonchalant. Well, here goes... "Meeeoowwww!"

Ten minutes later and two blocks away he sat on the lowest limb of the old Sycamore tree in the school yard. Casually he lifted his paw to lick his fur. Below him her paws braced on the trunk of the tree Brenda let go with another crescendo of barking. Damn he thought, Bogart was right, this could be the start of a beautiful friendship.

Snap-Shot: "Luck be a lady..." by Amy Popp

Today I watched long lines of people waiting to buy a lottery ticket. I just found out the jackpot is fifty-million dollars. It's so funny, in our modern, Internet, rush-paced world, to see people of all races and ethnicities eagerly standing on a city corner

waiting for their ticket, their chance for financial freedom, a "carefree" life. It's amazing in this cynical age that the "common" people still have hope in a lottery ticket and for that matter, the lottery system.



Travelogue by Matthew W. Weatherbee

We arrived in Bath, NY sometime around mid-day. It was a long drive and time didn't matter anymore. We were happy to have arrived and ready for anything but sitting. It was a nice site. To the north was an expansive view of sprawling farmland. To our west was a quaint little town that was conveniently located; close enough to get supplies, but far enough away to eliminate excessive bleed light. The eastern view was a mystery for we were parked literally at the foot of a small mountain. Geographers would probably call it a foothill, but looking to the peak from the foot would make one question any esoteric definitions.

There I stood stretching my legs with my brother and a bunch of our friends. There was an excitement building. The clean air smelled fresh from vegetation, unlike the trapped air of the city, and a gentle breeze that seemed to sweep away the filth of the road we arrived on. Immediately we started to split up in small groups with various interests, some wanted to set up camp and others wanted to take in the new environment. My brother and I stood looking up this "mountain" with a novel amazement. We didn't look at each other, but absorbed its magnitude together. I thought, "what a cool thing it would be to have this in your front lawn instead of some pastel garden gnome".

The mountain, though inanimate, challenged us. Its steep slope was threatening. The trees grew at a 45 degree angle interrupted only by glacial boulders. Our awe was interrupted by a friend, a crazy back-packer who travels to Yosemite National Park in the dead of winter just to see what it would be like to experience -50°F temperatures. He poked his head between my brother and I and said, "uhh, be kinda cool to climb this thing" in some kind of wise-cracker voice. He put his arms around us,

drawing us close and shaking us... "what do ya say?", he said with a wild grin and a laugh.

This set the three of us off running and yelling towards the mountain face. My first step up the mountain engaged me with a force that felt as though it would knock the wind from my lungs. The speed of my lateral sprint converted into upward vertical climb was very strenuous. The first 100 feet of the climb ended all wild jovial spirits and it became a strange unnecessary goal to reach the top. The three of us were racing upward away from the camp. The camp still seemed close, but I knew we were moving further and further because the hollering for us to return and help set up the camp became softer and more unintelligible. As we scrambled on kicking and clawing spraying rocks, leaves, mud and dirt in our wake, we came to a fire road. We stopped, but were not at the top. The view was beautiful. We rested then repeated our scramble onward and upward. The camp was getting smaller and smaller. I was tired. I was climbing at a very high rate. I was muddy. My boots were filling up with tiny stones. I had dirt in my pants. I was no longer having fun, but I still wanted to reach the top. We started talking about how close the top was, what the view would be like and joked like we were climbing Mount Everest. Then we came upon another fire road. We stopped for a break. We were all

doubled over, breathing heavy and spitting. We were so impulsive that we didn't bring any water so we were dehydrated as well. The view was amazing even though we weren't at the peak. We rested for some time and decided we didn't need to go any further. We couldn't see the camp because of the tops of the trees blocked the view below and that's when I realized that we had to climb all the way back down.



DISCLAIMER: As you can see from the preceding issue, we will print any opinion as long as you follow our submission guidelines. I feel that I should reiterate that the opinions printed here are not necessarily those of The Iconoclast. Please write to us because, no matter how controversial your submission is, it has to be better than this drivel of a disclaimer. (Please Note: This disclaimer does not necessarily reflect the opinions of the members of the Iconoclast or any of its members or readers. The preceeding has been a paid for announcement. If in case of a real emergency: the self-ass covering spew you have just read would be replaced with something of substantial intellectual value.).

THE ICONOCLAST brought to you by Andrea Chrisman, Anthony Simeone, Bruce Kramer & Amie Popp. Layout by Matthew W. Weatherbee. Writers o'rama: Jonathan Faszczuk, Jen Oliver, John Rothwell, Greg Pardlo, Bertram Redgrave, Nicole Nader, Tom Wright Jr., Susan Muaddi, Julie Kozempel, and Khary McGhee. Muses to the Writers: Shawn Sullivan, Valencia Johnson and Slappy Stink Head.

Please send all submissions, contributions, Ben and Jerry's, Gophered Scuppernon wine or chocolate of any kind (we especially like Godiva dark) to p00h@clam.rutgers.edu (the two O's are zeroes), or The Iconoclast, c/o P.O. Box 2133, Cinnaminson, NJ 08077. Remember we have a web page, so if you missed past issues, see us at <http://clam.rutgers.edu/~p00h/iconoclast/index.html>. (those two O's in p00h are also zeroes).